Installing SceneForge Outliner

SceneForge Outliner 1.0 beta · 3ds Max 2027 · install, update, uninstall

Requirements

- **3ds Max 2027** on Windows. This package supports no other version: the installer checks the version and stops if it does not match.
- No internet connection. SceneForge works offline and sends nothing anywhere.
- About 3 MB of disk space in your 3ds Max user folder. No administrator rights are needed.

> **Beta.** This beta build has no limits and needs no license key. **SceneForge > License...** shows the license as active for **Beta**.

Install

1. Save your work. Start 3ds Max 2027 (an empty or an open scene, both are fine).
2. Drag the SceneForge `.mzp` file you received from Windows Explorer onto a 3ds Max viewport. (Alternative: **Scripting > Run Script...** and pick the `.mzp` file.)
3. The installer checks the 3ds Max version, copies the files and checks every copied file.
4. It asks: *SceneForge Outliner has been installed. Open the panel now to check that it works?*
   Yes opens the panel right away (the installation summary then goes only to the MAXScript Listener, `F11`).
   No shows the summary window: the copied files, the path of this user guide, how to start the panel, where to report bugs and the line that uninstalls SceneForge.
5. **Restart 3ds Max** to get the **SceneForge** menu in the main menu bar. The commands in **Customize User Interface** work at once, without a restart.

Messages you may see instead:

MESSAGE	MEANING
This release of SceneForge is for: 3ds Max 2027. You are running it in 3ds Max ...	Wrong 3ds Max version. Nothing was installed.
The package is incomplete, NOTHING has been installed.	The .mzp file is damaged or incomplete. Get the file again.
SceneForge -- installation INCOMPLETE.	A file could not be copied (for example it was locked). The window lists it under PROBLEMS. The previous files were left unchanged. Restart 3ds Max and install again.

The SceneForge menu

After a restart the main menu bar has a **SceneForge** menu with ten commands. The same commands are in **Customize > Customize User Interface**, category **SceneForge**, so you can give them keys, toolbar buttons or quad menu entries.

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
SceneForge Outliner	Opens the panel (the first time it loads the plugin).
SceneForge - Scene reports	Opens the panel and its Reports window.
About SceneForge	Version, install folder and links: docs, roadmap, GitHub, e-mail, website.
License...	The license window. In this beta it shows **Beta**.
Documentation	Opens this guide (offline) or the PDFs online.
Report a bug...	Copies your set-up details; links to the GitHub form and e-mail.
Suggest a feature...	Links to the roadmap, the GitHub form and e-mail.
Roadmap (Trello)	Opens the public SceneForge roadmap: what is planned and in progress.
Discord community	Opens the Discord channel: questions, tips and news.
More plugins by the author	Opens forgeplugins.tech.

Where the files go

Everything goes into your own 3ds Max user folder, normally `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Autodesk\3dsMax\2027 - 64bit\ENU\` (`ENU` is the language of 3ds Max). The summary window shows the exact paths.

FOLDER	CONTENTS
`scripts\SceneForge\`	The plugin: panel, core, scene listener, start script, uninstaller, this user guide and `SceneForge_installed.txt` (the list of installed files).
`usermacros\SceneForge.mcr`	The ten commands of the SceneForge category.
`scripts\startup\`	A small script that adds the SceneForge menu when 3ds Max starts.
`plugcfg\SceneForge\`	Your settings, created on first use: `preferencje.json` (preferences), `skroty.json` (your shortcuts), `makra.json` (macros), saved views, scene rules, panel state and the panel log `dziennik_panelu.txt`.

> **Language profiles.** 3ds Max keeps a separate user folder per language. If you install while running 3ds Max in English and later start it in another language, install SceneForge again in that language.

Update to a newer build

- Drag the new `.mzp` onto a viewport, exactly like the first time.
- The installer replaces the plugin files and removes the older versions. Your settings, shortcuts, macros, saved views and rules in `plugcfg\SceneForge` are kept.
- If the panel was open, answer **Yes** to open the new panel, or simply **restart 3ds Max**. If you answer No, the previous panel keeps running until the next restart.

Uninstall

1. **Scripting > Run Script...**, open the folder `scripts\SceneForge` (the installation summary shows its full path) and run the file `SceneForge_odinstaluj_v...ms`.
2. Or: **Scripting > New Script**, paste the lines below and press `Ctrl`+`E` (Tools > Evaluate All):

```
(
  SF_odinst = getFiles ((getDir #userScripts) + "\\SceneForge\\SceneForge_odinstaluj_v*.ms")
  sort SF_odinst
  if SF_odinst.count > 0 then fileIn SF_odinst[SF_odinst.count]
  else messageBox "SceneForge is not installed."
)
```

- **It removes:** the open panel (it first leaves isolation and the viewport filter mode and restores painted wireframe colours), the scene callbacks and the scene listener, the SceneForge columns in the native Scene Explorer, the loaded core, the files listed in `SceneForge_installed.txt`, the commands file, the startup menu script and the listener's own log file.
- **It keeps:** your settings in `plugcfg\SceneForge` and any file in the plugin folder that SceneForge did not put there (the folder then stays). The final window lists what was removed, what was kept and where; delete the kept files by hand if you do not need them.
- Data already saved inside your .max files stays in those files (see *Privacy & footprint* in the User Guide).
- The menu entry disappears after you restart 3ds Max.

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
There is no SceneForge menu	Restart 3ds Max once after installing. Until then use Customize User Interface, category SceneForge.
The panel does not open	Run **SceneForge Outliner** from Customize User Interface and look at the MAXScript Listener (`F11`) for a message. Then use **Report a bug...**.
`Ctrl`+`P` pans the viewport	Panel shortcuts work only while the panel has focus. Click a row or the panel first.
Home / End / Page Up / Page Down move the time slider	Click a row so the list has focus. A green label *Home/End/PgUp/PgDn → list* on the bottom bar shows when the list owns these keys.
The list does not follow the scene	Check the **auto** box on the top bar, or click **Refresh**.